

The Latest in Protocol Analysers

Technology strides forward in leaps and bounds, enabling engineers to design and build even more sophisticated devices to improve productivity and performance. To ensure that the development process is successful, they need to be aware of the latest trends in protocol analysis, and that's where this article comes in



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Electronics engineers working with the latest technology understand that for successful product development, they need to ensure that every required step has been taken and completed precisely the way it was designed.

Protocol analysers are tools that optimise the engineers' product development by passively monitoring data transmissions on the bus, thus allowing them to see any possible error in the communication between a host device and the product.

What's fuelling their increased use

Even though most systems employ higher-level protocols, the simple fact is that any error can have a subtle effect on the overall device and system operating efficiencies. These seem-

ingly minor errors can later on grow to cause competitive disadvantages for the product and the company which developed it.

Derek Fung, vice president-business, Total Phase, explains, "System designers will want to detect and correct all possible sources of low-level data errors so that their designs can operate with the highest level of system performance. They can optimise product development to its fullest capacity with a protocol analyser."

Hundreds of new models of mobile devices have been released onto

the market in the recent years. The rapid expansion of mobile phone technology, explosive growth in the number of mobile devices, and multiple standards for 2G, 3G and LTE also contribute to the growth of protocol analysis.

Stephen Hire, general manager of Aeroflex Asia-India, adds, "Protocol analysis is a crucial part of mobile phone development. LTE is driving many new combinations of technology, all of which need to be tested thoroughly in order to ensure good customer experience. India's and China's adoption of the TD-LTE

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